

Ruth Nzikwikiza

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<https://github.com/RuthNzikwikiza> | <https://ruthportfolio-two.vercel.app/>

A forward-thinking Software Developer with a deep passion for technology and innovation. I enjoy exploring how code can shape ideas into meaningful digital experiences that make life easier and more connected. Guided by curiosity and a strong sense of purpose, I approach every project with creativity, problem-solving and a commitment to growth. My goal is to contribute to building a future where technology empowers people and drives positive change.

Skills

Computer Science Fundamentals: Data Structures, Algorithms, Algorithmic Thinking, Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), Software Design Patterns

Programming Languages: Python, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML/CSS ,TypeScript

Frameworks & Libraries: Django, Django REST Framework, React, Node.js,Express

Developer Tools: Git & GitHub, VS Code, Postman, Figma

Databases: PostgreSQL, SQLite

Other: API Development, UI Components, Cloud hosting (Render/Vercel,Netlify), User Experience Design

Soft Skills: Problem-Solving, Effective communication, Collaboration, Continuous improvement, Lifelong Learning.

Projects

E-Commerce Web Application(Nagahire Fashion Hub) / *Python, Django, React , CSS*

GitHub: - Frontend: <https://github.com/RuthNzikwikiza/Nagahire-FHF.git>

-Backend: <https://github.com/RuthNzikwikiza/Nagahire-FHB.git>

Live-demo: <https://nagahire-fhf-wzoh.vercel.app/>

- Developed a fashion e-commerce storefront branded as Nagahire Fashion Hub, enabling customers to browse and shop accurate clothing.
- Built a dynamic React frontend with product listing pages, category navigation, and a shopping interface designed to support real retail operations.
- Designed a clean, mobile-responsive UI using React and CSS, delivering an engaging shopping experience optimized for fashion-forward customers.

Portfolio(Emmy001 Photography)/ *Python, Django, React, CSS*

GitHub:-Frontend:<https://github.com/RuthNzikwikiza/Emmy-portfolio.git>

-Backend:<https://github.com/RuthNzikwikiza/Emmybackend-portfolio.git>

Live-demo:<https://emmy-portfolio-smoky.vercel.app/>

- Built a full stack photography portfolio website for a Musanze, Rwanda-based photographer, featuring a curated gallery of professional work in a clean, visually-driven layout with a complete backend API and admin management system.
- Architected a RESTful API backend using Django and Django REST Framework, with JWT authentication securing protected admin endpoints and PostgreSQL as the production database hosted on Render.

- Developed a responsive, image-first frontend using React and CSS, delivering an immersive browsing experience optimized for both desktop and mobile, deployed on Vercel.
- Implemented a password-protected admin dashboard allowing the photographer to independently upload, edit, and delete portfolio images without developer intervention, powered by Cloudinary for cloud-based image storage and delivery.
- Integrated Cloudinary's media management API for optimized image uploads, storage and fast delivery across the gallery.

Weather App(Sky Buddy)/HTML, CSS, JavaScript, WeatherAPI integration

GitHub:<https://github.com/RuthNzikwikiza/skybuddy.git>

Live-demo:<https://skybuddy-iwgs.vercel.app/>

- Developed a real-time weather application that automatically detects the user's location and fetches live weather data on page load, providing instant atmospheric conditions at a glance.
- Integrated a third-party Weather API to surface dynamic data including temperature, conditions, and forecasts, keeping users informed with up-to-date environmental information.
- Designed a lightweight, responsive interface using JavaScript and CSS, delivering a smooth and intuitive user experience across all screen sizes.

News App(Live Pulse)/HTML, CSS, JavaScript, NewsAPI integration

GitHub:<https://github.com/RuthNzikwikiza/livepulse.git>

Live-demo:<https://livepulse-3euk.vercel.app/>

- Developed a live news aggregation platform that fetches and displays real-time headlines across categories — Top, Business, Technology, Entertainment, and Sports — powered by [NewsAPI.org](https://newsapi.org/).
- Built a dynamic content rendering system in JavaScript that asynchronously loads and categorizes news articles, keeping users updated with the latest global stories.
- Designed a clean, category-filtered news feed interface with a built-in search feature, delivering a responsive and intuitive reading experience across devices.

UniStay+ (Group Project)/Node.js, Express, TypeScript, Prisma, PostgreSQL, React, JWT

GitHub: -Backend: <https://github.com/HMaxiime/UniStay-Backend.git>

- Frontend: <https://github.com/kirengasam05-dot/unistay-frontend.git>

Live-demo: <https://unistay-nu.vercel.app>

API Docs: <https://cdn-unistay.onrender.com/api-docs/>

- Collaborated in a team to build a student housing, job matching, and skill development platform serving university students.
- Designed and implemented the authentication and user management system on the backend using Node.js, Express, TypeScript, Prisma, and PostgreSQL, including JWT-based authentication, bcrypt password hashing, and email verification via Nodemailer.
- Contributed to the frontend authentication flow, connecting user-facing login and registration interfaces to the backend API.
- Resolved merge conflicts from teammates, fixed Prisma version incompatibilities, handled production database migration issues, and debugged CORS errors in deployment.
- Deployed backend on Render and frontend on Vercel, maintaining a production-ready API with full Swagger documentation.

Experience

Freelance + Personal Development Projects

October 2024 – Present

- Designed and built multiple full-stack web applications using Django, React and REST APIs, focusing on real-world usability and performance.
- Developed and deployed production-ready projects including an e-commerce platform, portfolio website and real-time data applications.
- Implemented key features such as authentication systems, API integrations, dynamic UI components and responsive design.
- Maintained professional GitHub repositories with version control, documentation and structured project organization.
- Collaborated with peers and mentors for code reviews, usability testing and continuous improvement.
- Strengthened expertise in problem-solving, debugging and translating ideas into functional digital products.

Education

Self-directed software engineering training

October 2024 – Present

- Pursuing intensive hands-on training in full-stack web development with focus on Django, React, REST APIs, PostgreSQL and modern JavaScript (ES6+).
- Built and deployed multiple web applications featuring authentication, database design, responsive UI/UX and third-party API integration.
- Applied computer science fundamentals including data structures, algorithms, object-oriented programming and software design patterns in project development.
- Maintained a structured 40+ hour weekly learning schedule through technical documentation, coding challenges and real-world project implementation.
- Strengthened development practices through mentorship, collaboration and continuous code improvement.

High School Diploma – Mathematics-Computer Science-Economics | Groupe Scolaire Rambura Fille

2021 – 2024

- Studied Calculus, Algebra, Statistics and Probability, building strong analytical and quantitative reasoning skills.
- Gained hands-on training in programming fundamentals, algorithms, databases, networking, and

web technologies.

- Studied micro/macroeconomics, business concepts and financial literacy, informing understanding of product and market dynamics.
- Completed coursework in Entrepreneurship, developing problem-solving and solution-design thinking transferable to real-world tech products.

References

- **Latifah UMUNYANA** - Software Developer at Ampersand Energy |
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